# Century Plyboards

## ADD

| | |
|---|---|
| Current Price (Rs) | : 778 |
| Target Price (Rs) | : 856 (854) |
| Potential change | : 10% |

**Market Data**

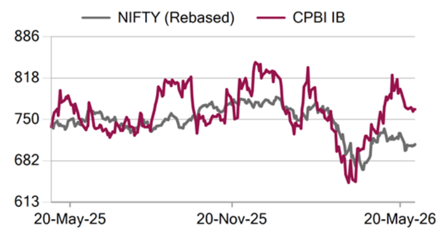
| | |
|---|---|
| No. of shares | : 223 mn |
| Free Float | : 28.2% |
| Market Cap (USD) | : 1,809 mn |
| 52-week High/ Low (Rs) | : 844/ 646 |
| Avg. Daily Volume (6M) | : 0.10 mn |
| Avg. Daily Value (6M;USD) | : 0.81 mn |
| Bloomberg Code | : CPBI IB |
| Promoters Holding | : 71.8% |
| FII / DII | : 4%/ 17% |

**Price Performance**

| (%) | 1M | 3M | 12M |
|---|---|---|---|
| Absolute | (0.5) | 3.8 | 2.2 |
| Relative | 1.3 | 9.1 | 5.2 |

Source: Refinitiv

**Share Price Performance**




Source: Refinitiv

## Q4 – strong performance; lack of clarity on growth for FY27

**CPBI's Q4 performance was largely driven by continued strong momentum in plywood, MDF, and ramp-up of particle board. CPBI has passed on major cost inflation. It announced capacity expansion in plywood/particle board at capex of ~Rs8.7bn, to be operational by Q1FY32. We cut FY27/28E earnings by 15/11%, mainly due to weak MDF margins despite strong volumes and high debt on books. We now value CPBI on FY28E (earlier Sep'27E) at 30x to arrive at a revised TP of Rs856 (from Rs854) and maintain ADD, factoring in revenue/EBITDA/PAT CAGRs of 15/29/54% over FY26-28E.**

### Strong growth in plywood continues, new capacity expansion in pipeline

Plywood revenues were up 19% YoY at Rs7.9bn on the back of strong volume growth and distribution expansion, with EBITDA margin at 15.8% vs 15% YoY/15.2% QoQ. CPBI indicated that current plywood plants are operating at near full utilization levels and hence FY27E will see ~30% capacity expansion (FY26 capacity at 4,06,000 CBM); it also announced expansion in Odisha at a capex of Rs2.3bn (Phase 1) and capacity of 60,000 CBM to be operational by Q1FY30 and Phase 2 (capex of Rs 1.4bn) with another 60,000 CBM by Q1FY31. Over the next year, the company intends to bring most of its outsourced production in-house. It is also conservatively planning all its future plywood expansion with 10-12% demand growth assumption and ~80% utilization benchmark. Timber prices were stable compared to prior years, although imported timber and chemical-related costs have risen due to freight and geopolitical disruptions. The company made ~7% price hikes in plywood in Apr to offset cost pressures.

### MDF continues to grow strong, plant to shut down in Q1 for debottlenecking

MDF revenues went up 32% YoY at Rs3.5bn driven by deeper penetration in the southern markets, network expansion, stronger engagement with carpenters and retailers, and dealer stocking ahead of expected price increases, while EBITDA margin was 9.8% vs 12.1% YoY/11.7% QoQ. A debottlenecking project at the Andhra Pradesh plant is expected to add 60,000–70,000 CBM capacity by Q1FY27E-end, while also improving operating efficiencies in power and fuel costs, for which CPBI will shut down the plant in Q1. The company remains structurally bullish on MDF and believes the segment can sustainably deliver high-teen EBITDA margins over time on operational improvements and increased value-added product-mix.

### Financial Summary Consolidated

| Y/E March | 2024 | 2025 | 2026E | 2027E | 2028E |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Net sales (Rs mn) | 38,860 | 45,278 | 53,972 | 62,003 | 71,701 |
| EBITDA (Rs mn) | 5,208 | 4,866 | 6,504 | 8,776 | 10,763 |
| PAT (Rs mn) | 3,253 | 1,861 | 2,683 | 4,727 | 6,353 |
| Con. EPS* (Rs) | - | - | 13.1 | 19.6 | 25.0 |
| FDEPS (Rs) | 14.6 | 8.4 | 12.1 | 21.2 | 28.5 |
| FDEPS growth (%) | -15.3 | -42.8 | 44.2 | 76.2 | 34.4 |
| Previous EPS (Rs) | - | - | 12.6 | 24.9 | 32.1 |
| ROE (%) | 14.7 | 7.8 | 10.2 | 15.3 | 17.2 |
| ROCE (%) | 15.9 | 9.3 | 11.2 | 16.8 | 19.9 |
| P/E (x) | 53.2 | 93.0 | 64.5 | 36.6 | 27.3 |
| EV/E (x) | 34.5 | 38.5 | 29.0 | 21.0 | 16.8 |

Note: *Consensus broker estimates"

Source: Company, Axis Capital

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**Bhavani Kumawat**
Research Analyst

## Conference call – key takeaways

- **Laminate segment:** Management acknowledged that laminates had gone through a subdued phase over the past couple of years because of internal go-to-market changes, leadership transitions, and evolving product-mix requirements in both domestic and export markets. However, FY26 showed early signs of recovery. The company attributed the improvement to corrective actions such as refining pricing strategies, sharpening distribution execution, leadership restructuring, and adding larger press capacities better suited for export-oriented products. CPBI believes the laminate business is now positioned to outperform industry growth rates going forward. Capacity utilization in laminates is already healthy at around mid-80s%, and the company appears focused more on improving product-mix and market execution rather than adding immediate large capacities.
- **Particle board segment:** The particle board business is still in the ramp-up phase, with management focusing on improving utilization and operating efficiencies at the newer continuous press plant. The older multi-daylight press plant has effectively been shut down and is unlikely to restart because management considers the technology outdated and inefficient. The company indicated that the old facility may eventually be scrapped entirely. On future expansion, management clarified that the recently announced Odisha proposal is still at a very preliminary stage under an MoU with the state government, and no final investment decision has been taken yet. Management also emphasized that particle board pricing remains largely relationship-driven because of the key-account nature of the business, rather than industry-wide list price increases. Cost inflation from chemicals has nevertheless been passed through selectively to customers.
- **Capex, expansion, and strategy:** Management repeatedly stressed that the company is entering a phase where sweating existing assets and improving return ratios are becoming equally important as growth. Large plywood expansions are underway because current plants are operating near peak utilization and internal expansion opportunities within existing plants are now largely exhausted. The company is actively pursuing land acquisition in Uttar Pradesh and Odisha to support future manufacturing growth, especially for plywood and potentially MDF or particle board in later years. Management clarified that there is currently no frozen large-scale capex for MDF or particle board beyond the ongoing MDF debottlenecking project. The approach going forward will be more measured, balancing growth opportunities with balance-sheet discipline. The company also stated that long-term debt is unlikely to exceed 1x EBITDA.
- **Pricing, raw materials, and industry outlook:** Sharp inflation in chemicals and resin-related inputs due to geopolitical tensions and global supply chain disruptions. MDF and particle board businesses saw industry-wide price increases of roughly 10-15%, while plywood pricing was increased by around 7%. The company repeatedly emphasized that the objective of price hikes is only to protect margins rather than expand them. Despite concerns around channel stocking in Mar, management indicated that Apr demand remained healthy across segments and secondary sales trends continued to be strong. The company remains optimistic on the long-term building materials opportunity, particularly in MDF and organized plywood categories.

## Exhibit 1: Change in estimates

| Particulars | Actual | Revised Estimates | | | Previous Estimates | | | % change | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | FY25 | FY26A | FY27E | FY28E | FY26E | FY27E | FY28E | FY26A | FY27E | FY28E |
| Revenue | 45,278 | 53,972 | 62,003 | 71,701 | 54,021 | 62,308 | 73,311 | 0% | 0% | -2% |
| EBITDA | 4,866 | 6,504 | 8,776 | 10,763 | 6,654 | 9,312 | 11,284 | -2% | -6% | -5% |
| EBITDA Margin | 10.7% | 12.1% | 14.2% | 15.0% | 12.3% | 14.9% | 15.4% | -27bps | -79bps | -38bps |
| PAT | 1,861 | 2,683 | 4,727 | 6,353 | 2,810 | 5,530 | 7,143 | -5% | -15% | -11% |
| EPS | 8 | 12 | 21 | 29 | 13 | 25 | 32 | -4% | -15% | -11% |

Source: Company, Axis Capital

## Exhibit 2: Quarterly performance

| Consolidated (Rs mn) | 4QFY26 | 4QFY25 | YoY (%) | 3QFY26 | QoQ(%) | 4QFY26E | vs Axis Est |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Revenue** | **14,922** | **11,983** | **24.5** | **13,501** | **10.5** | **14,073.7** | **6%** |
| EBITDA | 1,774 | 1,346 | 31.8 | 1,702 | 4.2 | 1,711.6 | 4% |
| EBITDA margin (%) | 11.9 | 11.2 | 66bps | 12.6 | -72bps | 12.2 | (27) |
| Depreciation | 495 | 360 | 37.6 | 483 | 2.5 | | |
| Other income | 47 | 20 | 135.4 | 17 | 178.5 | | |
| **PBIT** | **1,326** | **1,006** | **31.8** | **1,236** | **7.3** | | |
| Interest | 290 | 190 | 52.8 | 313 | (7.3) | | |
| **PBT** | **1,037** | **817** | **26.9** | **924** | **12.2** | | |
| Exceptional item | (1) | - | | (76) | | | |
| **PBT** | **1,036** | **817** | **26.9** | **848** | **22.2** | | |
| Tax | 242 | 285 | (15.2) | 197 | 22.6 | | |
| Tax rate (%) | 23.34 | 34.91 | -1157bps | 23.27 | 7bps | | |
| **Net Profit** | **794** | **532** | **49.4** | **650** | **22.1** | **744.1** | **7%** |

Source: Company, Axis Capital

## Exhibit 3: Segmental performance

| Segment-wise results | 4QFY26 | 4QFY25 | YoY (%) | 3QFY26 | QoQ(%) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Revenues:** | | | | | |
| Plywood | 7,911 | 6,707 | 18% | 7,102 | 11% |
| Laminates | 1,984 | 1,704 | 16% | 1,830 | 8% |
| MDF | 3,563 | 2,709 | 32% | 3,258 | 9% |
| Particle Board | 679 | 326 | 108% | 654 | 4% |
| Logistics | 507 | 364 | 39% | 421 | 20% |
| Others | 287 | 187 | 53% | 242 | 19% |
| Segment Revenue | 14,931 | 11,998 | 24% | 13,507 | 11% |
| Less: Inter segment revenue | 9 | 15 | | 6 | |
| **Total Revenue** | **14,922** | **11,983** | **25%** | **13,501** | **11%** |
| **Segment PBIT** | | | | | |
| Plywood | 1,175 | 884 | 33% | 1,038 | 13% |
| Laminates | 174 | (49) | -456% | 82 | 111% |
| MDF | 228 | 153 | 49% | 228 | 0% |
| Particle Board | (61) | (3) | 1710% | (105) | -42% |
| Logistics | 17 | 33 | -50% | 52 | -68% |
| Others | 34 | (10) | -452% | 44 | -22% |
| Less:Interest | (290) | (190) | 53% | (313) | -7% |
| Less:Unallocated Expenses | (240) | (3) | 8884% | (179) | 34% |
| **Total PBIT** | **1,036** | **817** | **27%** | **848** | **22%** |
| **Segmental Margin(%)** | | | | | |
| Plywood | 14.9% | 13.2% | 167bps | 14.6% | 24bps |
| Laminates | 8.7% | -2.9% | 1161bps | 4.5% | 426bps |
| MDF | 6.4% | 5.7% | 74bps | 7.0% | -62bps |
| Particle Board | -9.0% | -1.0% | -798bps | -16% | 705bps |
| Logistics | 3.3% | 9% | -580bps | 12% | -917bps |
| Others | 11.8% | -5% | 1695bps | 18% | -616bps |
| **Total PBIT Margin** | **6.9%** | **7%** | **13bps** | **6%** | **66bps** |

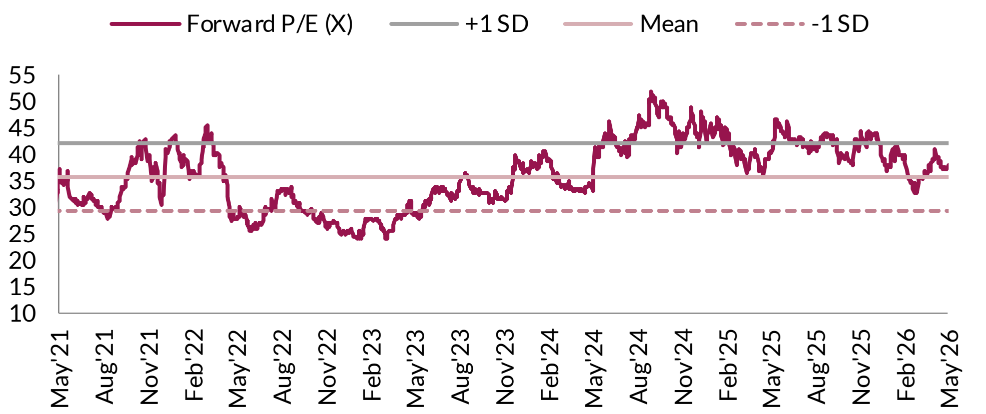
Source: Company, Axis Capital

## Exhibit 4: Volumes, realizations, and EBITDA

| Volumes & Realisations | 4QFY26 | 4QFY25 | YoY (%) | 3QFY26 | QoQ (%) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Volumes** | | | | | |
| Plywood - (In CBM) | 1,39,255 | 1,11,884 | 24% | 1,24,564 | 12% |
| Laminates - (In Sheets) | 18,65,362 | 18,76,498 | -1% | 16,68,993 | 12% |
| MDF - (In CBM) | 1,21,714 | 87,549 | 39% | 1,11,152 | 10% |
| Particle Board | 36,182 | 14,970 | 142% | 36,158 | 0% |
| | | | | | |
| **Realisations** | **4QFY26** | **4QFY25** | **YoY (%)** | **3QFY26** | **QoQ(%)** |
| Plywood - (Rs CBM) | 56,742 | 58,358 | -3% | 56,711 | 0% |
| Laminates - (Rs/Sheet) | 1,036 | 875 | 18% | 1,058 | -2% |
| MDF - (Rs/CBM) | 28,967 | 30,521 | -5% | 29,095 | 0% |
| Particle Board - Rs/CBM) | 18,429 | 21,222 | -13% | 17,755 | 4% |
| **EBITDA Realisations** | **4QFY26** | **4QFY25** | **YoY (%)** | **3QFY26** | **QoQ(%)** |
| Plywood - (Rs CBM) | 8,997 | 8,887 | 1% | 8,687 | 4% |
| Laminates - (Rs/Sheet) | 121 | 9 | 1306% | 99 | 23% |
| MDF - (Rs/CBM) | 2,862 | 3,730 | -23% | 3,441 | -17% |
| Particle Board - Rs/CBM) | (1,061) | 1,142 | -193% | (509) | 109% |

Source: Company, Axis Capital

## Exhibit 5: 1-year-forward P/E chart




Source: Refinitive, Axis Capital

# Financial Summary Consolidated

## Profit & Loss (Rs mn)

| Y/E March | 2024 | 2025 | 2026E | 2027E | 2028E |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Net sales | 38,860 | 45,278 | 53,972 | 62,003 | 71,701 |
| Other operating income | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| **Total operating income** | **38,860** | **45,278** | **53,972** | **62,003** | **71,701** |
| Cost of goods sold | (20,354) | (24,338) | (27,765) | (31,621) | (36,568) |
| Gross profit | 18,506 | 20,940 | 26,207 | 30,381 | 35,134 |
| Gross margin (%) | 48 | 46 | 49 | 49 | 49 |
| Total operating expenses | (13,298) | (16,075) | (19,703) | (21,605) | (24,371) |
| **EBITDA** | **5,208** | **4,866** | **6,504** | **8,776** | **10,763** |
| EBITDA margin (%) | 13 | 11 | 12 | 14 | 15 |
| Depreciation | (947) | (1,372) | (1,821) | (1,991) | (2,122) |
| **EBIT** | **4,261** | **3,494** | **4,683** | **6,786** | **8,641** |
| Net interest | (308) | (690) | (1,135) | (791) | (581) |
| Other income | 439 | 103 | 102 | 300 | 400 |
| **Profit before tax** | **4,392** | **2,773** | **3,574** | **6,295** | **8,459** |
| Total taxation | (1,138) | (912) | (890) | (1,567) | (2,106) |
| Tax rate (%) | 26 | 33 | 25 | 25 | 25 |
| Profit after tax | 3,253 | 1,861 | 2,683 | 4,727 | 6,353 |
| Minorities | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| Profit/ Loss associate co(s) | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| Adjusted net profit | 3,253 | 1,861 | 2,683 | 4,727 | 6,353 |
| Adj. PAT margin (%) | 8 | 4 | 5 | 8 | 9 |
| Net non-recurring items | 0 | (133) | (77) | 0 | 0 |

## Balance Sheet (Rs mn)

| Y/E March | 2024 | 2025 | 2026E | 2027E | 2028E |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Paid-up capital | 223 | 223 | 223 | 223 | 223 |
| Reserves & surplus | 21,894 | 23,429 | 25,876 | 30,381 | 36,512 |
| Net worth | 22,117 | 23,651 | 26,099 | 30,604 | 36,734 |
| Borrowing | 7,184 | 14,737 | 16,301 | 11,301 | 8,301 |
| Other non-current liabilities | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| **Total liabilities** | **35,526** | **45,682** | **50,718** | **50,900** | **54,716** |
| Gross fixed assets | 25,212 | 27,874 | 37,311 | 39,811 | 43,311 |
| Less: Depreciation | (6,139) | (7,511) | (9,332) | (11,322) | (13,444) |
| Net fixed assets | 19,073 | 20,363 | 27,980 | 28,489 | 29,867 |
| Add: Capital WIP | 2,666 | 7,299 | 1,881 | 881 | 381 |
| Total fixed assets | 21,739 | 27,661 | 29,861 | 29,370 | 30,248 |
| Total Investment | 89 | 89 | 117 | 117 | 117 |
| Inventory | 6,456 | 9,866 | 10,871 | 11,089 | 12,695 |
| Debtors | 4,168 | 5,000 | 6,176 | 6,889 | 7,967 |
| Cash & bank | 671 | 491 | 590 | 332 | 586 |
| Loans & advances | 25 | 73 | 81 | 81 | 81 |
| Current liabilities | 5,874 | 6,972 | 7,983 | 8,660 | 9,345 |
| Net current assets | 7,823 | 10,959 | 12,757 | 12,753 | 15,006 |
| Other non-current assets | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| **Total assets** | **35,526** | **45,682** | **50,718** | **50,900** | **54,716** |

Source: Company, Axis Capital

## Cash Flow (Rs mn)

| Y/E March | 2024 | 2025 | 2026E | 2027E | 2028E |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Profit before tax | 4,392 | 2,773 | 3,574 | 6,295 | 8,459 |
| Depreciation & Amortisation | (947) | (1,372) | (1,821) | (1,991) | (2,122) |
| Chg in working capital | (1,958) | (3,978) | (1,309) | (254) | (1,999) |
| **Cash flow from operations** | **2,517** | **(27)** | **4,570** | **6,955** | **6,658** |
| Capital expenditure | (8,446) | (6,635) | (4,095) | (1,500) | (3,000) |
| **Cash flow from investing** | **(5,781)** | **(6,781)** | **(4,249)** | **(1,200)** | **(2,600)** |
| Equity raised/ (repaid) | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| Debt raised/ (repaid) | 4,049 | 7,509 | 988 | (5,000) | (3,000) |
| Dividend paid | (222) | (222) | (222) | (223) | (223) |
| **Cash flow from financing** | **3,530** | **6,603** | **(221)** | **(6,014)** | **(3,804)** |
| Net chg in cash | 266 | (205) | 100 | (258) | 254 |

## Key Ratios

| Y/E March | 2024 | 2025 | 2026E | 2027E | 2028E |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **OPERATIONAL** | | | | | |
| FDEPS (Rs) | 14.6 | 8.4 | 12.1 | 21.2 | 28.5 |
| CEPS (Rs) | 18.9 | 13.9 | 19.9 | 30.2 | 38.1 |
| DPS (Rs) | 1.0 | 1.0 | 1.0 | 1.0 | 1.0 |
| Dividend payout ratio (%) | 6.8 | 12.9 | 8.5 | 4.7 | 3.5 |
| **GROWTH** | | | | | |
| Net sales (%) | 6.6 | 16.5 | 19.2 | 14.9 | 15.6 |
| EBITDA (%) | (6.8) | (6.6) | 33.7 | 34.9 | 22.6 |
| Adj net profit (%) | (15.3) | (42.8) | 44.2 | 76.2 | 34.4 |
| FDEPS (%) | (15.3) | (42.8) | 44.2 | 76.2 | 34.4 |
| **PERFORMANCE** | | | | | |
| RoE (%) | 14.7 | 7.8 | 10.2 | 15.3 | 17.2 |
| RoCE (%) | 15.9 | 9.3 | 11.2 | 16.8 | 19.9 |
| **EFFICIENCY** | | | | | |
| Asset turnover (x) | 1.9 | 1.7 | 1.7 | 1.6 | 1.7 |
| Sales/ total assets (x) | 1.2 | 1.1 | 1.1 | 1.2 | 1.4 |
| Working capital/ sales (x) | 0.2 | 0.2 | 0.2 | 0.2 | 0.2 |
| Receivable days | 39.1 | 40.3 | 41.8 | 40.6 | 40.6 |
| Inventory days | 70.0 | 89.1 | 83.6 | 76.0 | 76.0 |
| Payable days | 31.0 | 32.3 | 31.2 | 32.4 | 32.4 |
| **FINANCIAL STABILITY** | | | | | |
| Total debt/ equity (x) | 0.3 | 0.6 | 0.7 | 0.4 | 0.2 |
| Net debt/ equity (x) | 0.3 | 0.6 | 0.6 | 0.4 | 0.2 |
| Current ratio (x) | 2.3 | 2.6 | 2.6 | 2.5 | 2.6 |
| Interest cover (x) | 13.8 | 5.1 | 4.1 | 8.6 | 14.9 |
| **VALUATION** | | | | | |
| PE (x) | 53.2 | 93.0 | 64.5 | 36.6 | 27.3 |
| EV/ EBITDA (x) | 34.5 | 38.5 | 29.0 | 21.0 | 16.8 |
| EV/ Net sales (x) | 4.6 | 4.1 | 3.5 | 3.0 | 2.5 |
| PB (x) | 7.8 | 7.3 | 6.6 | 5.7 | 4.7 |
| Dividend yield (%) | 0.6 | 0.6 | 0.6 | 0.6 | 0.6 |
| Free cash flow yield (%) | (16.3) | (18.4) | 1.3 | 15.0 | 10.1 |

## RATINGS & DEFINITIONS

| FUNDAMENTAL RESEARCH | | ALTERNATIVE RESEARCH | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **BUY** | We expect this stock to deliver more than 15% returns over the next 12 months. | **TACTICAL LONG** | We expect this stock to deliver >10% returns over the next 45 days. |
| **ADD** | We expect this stock to deliver 5-15% returns over the next 12 months. | **TACTICAL SHORT** | We expect this stock to deliver <-10% returns over the next 45 days. |
| **REDUCE** | We expect this stock to deliver 5% to -10% returns over the next 12 months. | **RELATIVE LONG** | We expect this stock to outperform the benchmark/stock (specified in this report) by 10% or more over the next 45 days. |
| **SELL** | We expect this stock to deliver <-10% returns over the next 12 months. | **RELATIVE SHORT** | We expect this stock to underperform the benchmark/stock (specified in this report) by 10% or more over the next 45 days. |

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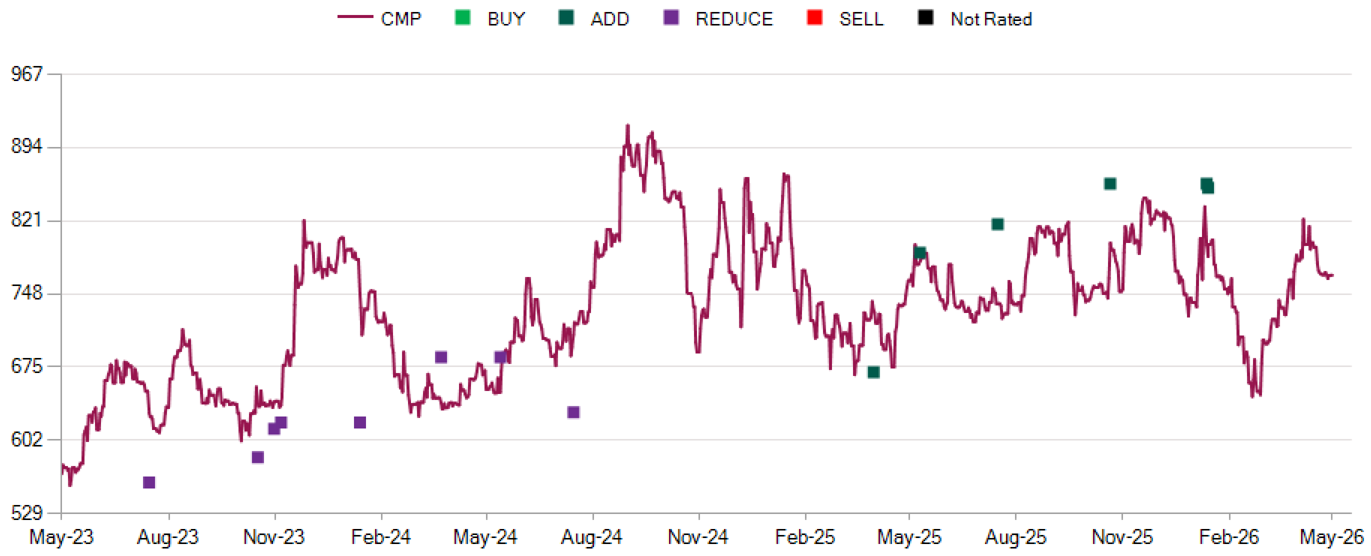
## Century Plyboards (CPBI IB, CNTP.NS) Price and Recommendation History




| S.No. | Date | CMP | Reco | TP |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 05-Feb-26 | 786 | Add | 854 |
| 2 | 04-Feb-26 | 797 | Add | 858 |
| 3 | 13-Nov-25 | 799 | Add | 858 |
| 4 | 08-Aug-25 | 738 | Add | 818 |
| 5 | 02-Jun-25 | 781 | Add | 790 |
| 6 | 23-Apr-25 | 732 | Add | 670 |
| 7 | 07-Aug-24 | 707 | Reduce | 630 |
| 8 | 05-Jun-24 | 650 | Reduce | 685 |
| 9 | 15-Apr-24 | 639 | Reduce | 685 |
| 10 | 05-Feb-24 | 748 | Reduce | 620 |
| 11 | 29-Nov-23 | 637 | Reduce | 620 |
| 12 | 23-Nov-23 | 640 | Reduce | 613 |

Source: Axis Capital